Section 3 How You Obtain Care

Identification Cards/ Enrollment Confirmation

We will send you an identification (ID) card when you enroll within 15 days of your effective date. You must show it whenever you receive services from a plan provider.

If you do not receive your ID card within 30 days after the effective date of your enrollment, or if you need replacement cards, call us at (877) 434-2336 or write us at: G.E.H.A Enrollment, P.O. Box 21262, Eagan, MN 55121.

Existing members who were previously issued an ID card will not receive new ID cards unless otherwise requested or G.E.H.A receives a name change/correction or change in plan from BENEFEDS.

You may also print a temporary ID card after signing in to your member account on our website: www.geha.com/FEDVIPInfo.

It is important to bring your FEDVIP and FEHB/PSHB identification cards to every dental appointment because most FEHB/PSHB plans offer some level of dental benefits separate from your FEDVIP coverage. Presenting both identification cards can ensure that you receive the maximum allowable benefit under both Programs.

Where You Get Covered Care

You may get care from any "covered provider." However, if you use our preferred providers, you may pay less because a preferred provider has agreed to limit charges to our maximum allowed charge for covered services.

Plan Providers

Each covered person has the right to choose any licensed dental practitioner. We list plan providers in the provider directory, which we update periodically. The list is on our website at www.geha.com/find-dental-care. You may also call us at (877) 434-2336 for help in locating a preferred provider.

In-Network

Care that you receive from an in-network preferred provider (PPO). To obtain care, simply select a provider and make an appointment. Referrals to a specialist are not necessary. The plan does not require you to see a primary care provider before seeing a specialist. Information on preferred dentists can be obtained free of charge. Visit our website at www.geha.com/find-dental-care or call (877) 434-2336.

The list of preferred providers is subject to change. Before you receive care, it is your responsibility to verify with the preferred provider that the provider currently participates at the office location where you will be seen.

G.E.H.A does not guarantee that preferred providers are available for all specialties, are available in all areas or that the Connection Dental Maximum Allowable Charge is less than what you might obtain from non-preferred providers.

Out-of-Network

Care that you receive from a provider that does not participate in our network of providers. G.E.H.A reimburses for covered dental care from any covered provider. Non-PPO providers have no agreement to limit what they will bill you.

Pre-Determination

The plan does not require a pre-determination of benefits. G.E.H.A will respond to a request to pre-determine services with an estimate of covered service, which is non-binding and not a guarantee of payment since future changes such as changes in your enrollment or eligibility under the plan may affect benefits. We encourage you to ask your provider to request a pre-determination for any extensive treatment. By obtaining a pre-determination, you and your dental provider will have an estimate before treatment begins of what will be covered and how it will be paid. This information can be valuable to you in making an informed decision on how to proceed with treatment and can help protect you from unexpected out-of-pocket costs should the treatment plan not be covered.

Pre-determinations are valid through the calendar year in which they are prepared, or 12 months, subject to eligibility and plan limitations.